

of the general trend. While kids were able to access these cheap networked technologies to further their studies, it was only when they were supervised that they naturally used it for educational purposes. In most cases, the program was only one-sided, where children were introduced to the technology but were never guided towards how to make the most of it for education-specific purposes.

In addition to the detrimental effects of parental complacency and lack of content management, researchers have also noticed the deeper psychological effects of social networking amongst younger peer groups. Many serious social and psychological problems such as bullying and depression are being detected amongst younger children who are on social networks. The impact of peer-group bullying is significantly magnified amongst these closed and anonymous spaces, where it becomes easier to victimise and abuse kids. And due to the shifting importance of social network influence, it's becoming more frequent among these peer groups to undergo



Cyber bullies could be threatening your child

extreme behaviour, which results in higher anxiety often times associated with being “popular” and “friended” online. The perils become significantly amplified for early teens who operate on more intimate mediums such as Snapchat, where very private information is traded.

Above and beyond all these persistent risks lies the general risk of child predators. The anonymity of the networked space and easy-to-infiltrate social network systems help many sexual predators exploit and entrap children online. While instances of online sexual child predators in India are scarcely reported, it's usually due to lack of willingness to come forward as opposed to lack of incidences. At the core of it all lies unprepared children who are left to wander the dangerous grounds of the online space. These children can not only inadvertently be a risk to each other, but also place themselves in risky scenarios purely out of lack of any personalised education.

For parents, the role of technology in the household is an afterthought – the devices are considered just passive appliances, and little or no thought